



A MOTHER'S HEARTBREAK

■ A Pakistani citizen (centre) bids goodbye to her son, an Indian citizen, as she prepares to return to her country through the India-Pakistan Wagah border post, about 35km from Amritsar yesterday. The departure of Pakistani nationals from India through the Attari border saw a significant rise yesterday, coinciding with the last day of validity for medical visas issued to them as per the Indian government's decision.

SEE ALSO P11

Revised timings in UAE schools

Student well-being prioritised amid rising temperatures

ABU DHABI
BY ALI AL HAMMADI
Reporter

Starting Monday, most schools in the UAE began following a revised timetable, with classes running from 7.15am to 1.35pm, Monday through Thursday, and from 7.15am to 11am on Fridays.

This is in response to soaring temperatures and growing concerns from parents and to ensure student comfort and safety while maintaining educational quality.

The decision comes as part of a broader move to align

NCM GUIDELINES

- Stay hydrated by drinking plenty of water and fluids.
- Avoid direct exposure to sunlight during peak hours.
- Wear light-coloured, breathable cotton clothing.
- Use protective accessories like hats and sunglasses.

school operations with the country's flexible learning framework, while still upholding the academic standards set by the Ministry of Education. Lesson durations will remain consistent with ministry regulations.

School administrations have issued clear attendance

guidelines, stating that school gates will open at 7am and close at 7.30am.

Late arrivals must be justified by a guardian through direct communication with school officials.

The heat is on

Meanwhile, the National Center of Meteorology (NCM) has warned residents of soaring temperatures across the UAE this week, as hot southerly winds drive a sharp rise in heat across the country.

The UAE experienced a scorching day yesterday, with temperatures exceeding 45°C. According to NCM, the highest temperature recorded in the country was 46°C in Al Shawamekh (Abu Dhabi) at 1.15pm yesterday.

SEE ALSO P2

72,000 migrants dead or missing since 2014: UN

52,000 DIED TRYING TO ESCAPE FROM NATIONS HAVING UN RESPONSE PLAN

GENEVA

More than 72,000 deaths and disappearances have been documented along migration routes around the world in the past decade, most of them in crisis-affected countries, the United Nations said yesterday.

Last year saw the highest migrant death toll on record, with at least 8,938 people dying on migration routes, according to the International Organisation for Migration (IOM).

"These numbers are a tragic reminder that people risk their lives when insecurity, lack of opportunity, and other pressures leave them with no safe or viable options at home," IOM chief Amy Pope said in a statement.

The report by her UN agency found that nearly three-quarters of all migrant deaths and disappearances recorded globally since 2014 occurred as people fled insecurity, conflict, disaster and other humanitarian crises.

Afghans, Rohingya, and Syrians make up the dead

One in four were "from countries affected by humanitarian crises, with the deaths of thousands of Afghans, Rohingya, and Syrians documented on migration routes worldwide", said the IOM's Missing Migrants Report.

The report said that more than 52,000 people died while trying to escape from one of the 40 countries in the world where the UN has a crisis response plan or humanitarian response plan in place.

Pope urged international in-

25,000

people were lost at sea in the Central Mediterranean

8,938

died on migration routes in 2024, highest on record

vestment "to create stability and opportunity within communities, so that migration is a choice, not a necessity".

"And when staying is no longer possible, we must work together to enable safe, legal, and orderly pathways that protect lives."

The Central Mediterranean remains the deadliest migration route in the world, with nearly 25,000 people lost at sea in the past decade, IOM said.

More than 12,000 of those had been lost at sea after departing from war-torn Libya, with countless others disappearing while transiting the Sahara Desert, the report said.

More than 5,000 people died while trying to leave crisis-ravaged Afghanistan in the past decade, many of them since the Taliban retook power in 2021.

And more than 3,100 members of Myanmar's persecuted Rohingya minority had died during the period, many in shipwrecks or while crossing into Bangladesh.

— AFP

TELL ME WHY VACCINES PROTECT LIVES

Dr. Nadine Tarcha, Pfizer's Gulf Medical Director, explains the importance of immunisation



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Rolls-Royce joins Dubai Police's tourist patrol fleet

It can be seen at Dubai Frame, Dubai Mall

DUBAI
BY ASHWANI KUMAR
Chief Reporter

Dubai Police has unveiled a new addition to its tourist patrol fleet — a majestic Rolls-Royce that is turning heads and stealing the spotlight at the Arabian Travel Market 2025.

Known for its opulence, the Rolls-Royce takes on a new role of being an ambassador of Dubai's world-class tourism and safety services. With a price tag ranging from Dh2 million to Dh3 million, it is the most expensive luxury vehicle in Dubai Police's

fleet. This will be the most expensive vehicle in our tourist patrol fleet. You will find this Rolls-Royce on the streets of popular tourist



sites across the city like Dubai Frame, Dubai Mall, museums, and heritage sites," a police officer told Gulf News.

Since being displayed at the event, the car has attracted curious visitors who have been taking selfies and recording videos. But the Rolls-Royce is more than just a showstopper — it's a strategic addition aimed at engaging with tourists both in the city and abroad. "This car is not just staying in Dubai. We will even take it outside the country. Tourists can take photos with it. It's about making our services more accessible," he added.

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